

DEMO LEGAL CASE FILE

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Field	Extracted Information
Case Title	Rajesh Kumar vs State of Maharashtra
Court	Supreme Court of India
Judgment Date	14 March 2024
Judges	Justice A.K. Sharma, Justice R. Mehta
Petitioner	Rajesh Kumar
Respondent	State of Maharashtra
Acts Involved	Indian Penal Code, 1860; Information Technology Act, 2000
Constitutional Articles	Article 14, Article 19(1)(a), Article 21
Case Type	Criminal Appeal
Case Number	Criminal Appeal No. 248 of 2024

Background of the Case

The petitioner, Rajesh Kumar, filed a criminal appeal challenging the decision of the Bombay High Court which upheld his conviction under provisions related to cyber fraud and identity theft. The case originated from allegations that the petitioner unlawfully accessed confidential financial information and used digital platforms to conduct unauthorized transactions.

Key Legal Issues

- Whether the digital evidence collected by the investigating agency was admissible.
- Whether the petitioner's right to privacy under Article 21 was violated during investigation.
- Whether procedural safeguards under the Information Technology Act were properly followed.
- Whether the conviction based primarily on electronic records was legally sustainable.

Important Observations by the Court

The Court observed that electronic evidence must satisfy authenticity and integrity requirements before being relied upon in criminal proceedings. It further emphasized that investigative agencies must strictly comply with procedural safeguards while collecting digital evidence.

The bench also highlighted the growing importance of cybersecurity jurisprudence and the necessity for balancing individual privacy rights with effective criminal investigation.

Arguments by the Petitioner

The petitioner argued that the digital records were obtained without lawful authorization and that the chain of custody for electronic evidence was incomplete. It was further argued that the prosecution failed to establish direct involvement beyond reasonable doubt.

Arguments by the Respondent

The State contended that all evidence was collected in accordance with statutory procedure and supported by forensic certification. The prosecution argued that financial transaction records, IP logs, and recovered devices collectively established the petitioner's involvement.

Final Verdict

The Supreme Court partially allowed the appeal. The Court upheld the admissibility of the electronic evidence but reduced the sentence imposed by the High Court, considering mitigating circumstances and procedural lapses during investigation.

Summary

This case demonstrates the evolving judicial approach toward digital evidence, cybercrime investigation, and constitutional protections in the digital era. The judgment reinforces the importance of procedural compliance and evidentiary integrity in technology-related criminal matters.

AI-Generated Brief

Based on the extracted legal content, the case primarily concerns admissibility of electronic evidence, constitutional privacy protections, and procedural fairness in cybercrime investigations. The Court balanced technological enforcement needs with individual constitutional safeguards while interpreting provisions of the Information Technology Act and the Indian Constitution.

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